Cédric Sounard



Your Most Extroverted Geek

AI-native go-to-market, partnerships & community operator · Brussels

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AI-native extrovert. In 2010 I'd have been the non-technical sales-CEO who can't code. Today AI is my superpower, and I now **win hackathons solo**. Philosopher by training (PPE, Utrecht), I turn **partnerships, community and go-to-market** into momentum, and I do my sharpest work against a tight deadline.

SELECTED HIGHLIGHTS

620 delegates · 1,000 registrations

Chief of Staff, AI in Defence Summit. NATO, 6 Ministries of Defence, EU Defence Commissioner Kubilius; Oracle · Thales · Axelera.

13 hackathons organised or facilitated

Stripe & Collibra-backed · **Stripe Community Builder** · founder of Hackathons Makers Exchange. I also **win hackathons solo** (Wintercircus: Soda Straw × Anthropic).

€250k in charity donations

Raised door-to-door & street for Oxfam, the Red Cross & others, at 17. Where the sales DNA started.

100 members · 5,000 visitors/yr

Cofounder & board member, Commons Hub Brussels, a collaborative space run as a commons.

EXPERIENCE

Cofounder · Seven Events — 2025–present

Premium event agency · high-impact business forums & tech summits · Brussels

- Co-founded with Sona Stepanjan (CEO, ex-EEAS) and Jérôme Leclanche (CTO/CFO; a €10M+ exit under his belt). I drive partnerships and client relationships.
- **Chief of Staff, AI in Defence Summit** (flagship). Ran the room for **620 approved delegates from 1,000 registrations**: NATO, six national Ministries of Defence, EU Defence Commissioner Andrius Kubilius, plus Oracle, Thales and Axelera.

Cofounder & Board Member · Commons Hub Brussels — 2024–present

Collaborative space run as a commons · board member (1 of 7) since 2026

- Cofounder, community & events steward since 2024; now on the board. Dual economy (euros + CHT tokens); **100 members, 5,000 visitors/year**, the physical home for many of my events.

Chief of Relations + Events · North Star — Aug–Dec 2025

Making Europe the place to build in AI & robotics

- Crafted partnerships with cutting-edge companies: **Stripe, Lovable, Ingram.tech, Hugging Face**, robotics labs and Belgian tech hubs.
- Co-led the country's most active **kids' AI-coding hackathon**: 8 venues across 6 Belgian cities in parallel, on extreme funding efficiency.

GTM Associate · inflights — Dec 2024–May 2025

Utility-scale solar

- Go-to-market for **gigawatt-scale solar panel fields**. Ran **8 revenue experiments**, landed a client at a scale hard to keep up with, and cut lost leads by an order of magnitude.

GTM Associate · HRMano — 2026–present

Pre-launch fintech for Belgian founders

- Go-to-market to **Belgian founders** for a pre-launch social-secretariat platform; supporting a live equity raise (Spreds).

Founder · Matrics Solve — 2023–present

Event-services company · WeAreFounders incubator (Google & BeAngels-backed)

- Started as a search engine for events; we didn't ship fast enough and shelved the app — my defining lesson that **speed beats polish**, which is exactly why I now ship and win hackathons solo.
- Pivoted the company from an app **about** events into event **services** and founding event brands — turning that lesson into the domain expertise I'd been missing.

Recruiter / Ambassador · Direct Result Marketing 2018–2019

First sales role · age 17

- Raised **€250,000 in charity donations** for Oxfam, the Red Cross and other NGOs (door-to-door & street) over 10 months; trained **60+ teammates**, at seventeen.

SELECTED EVENTS & HACKATHONS

- **AI in Defence Summit**: Chief of Staff. NATO, 6 Ministries of Defence, Commissioner Kubilius; Oracle · Thales · Axelera.
- **Agentic Commerce & E-invoicing Hackathon**: with Collibra × Stripe, via Seven Events; editions on 27 June and 3 October 2026 (105 signups, a record).
- **EU Agri-Hackathon**: European Commission (DG AGRI) with ICF Next, 16–18 October 2026; one of 3 facilitators, up to 30 teams.
- **Next up: Hack the Rails**: 21 November 2026, Brussels; European Sleeper as lead sponsor, with the City of Brussels.
- **Decentralised European Media Hackathon**: FOSDEM week, 40 builders: senior policy & media figures alongside students.
- **Energy Data Visualisation Hackathon**: City of Brussels (main sponsor), Sibelga & Collibra; making energy data legible.
- **Wintercircus, Ghent**: solo win at a 20-partner hackathon (Soda Straw, Anthropic). Took the Loop (earplugs) track; prize: a drive at Spa-Francorchamps.

CIVIC & PUBLIC LIFE

- **Assemblée Citoyenne pour le Climat** (Food, cycle 2): 70 citizens, 33 initiatives. Led the **food-waste and data-gathering** work across the assembly's 33 recommendations, and sit on the **7-person committee** following up the assembly's full Food cycle with the minister's cabinet. Coordinated **saving 1+ tonne of food** (with VBO-FEB & Commons Hub).
- **Public life & thought leadership**: Degrowth conference @ EU Parliament (2024); "Designing Dialogue at Scale" with Cronos Europa @ Flagey. Working thesis: modern democracy runs on absurdly low bandwidth, and we can now let citizens participate far more granularly.
- **Community building**: Cofounder, **Founders Running Club Brussels** (Nov 2025; 130 in the group). Connective tissue across **30+ Belgian incubators & communities**: Wintercircus, WAT, BeCentral, Betacowork, Pulse, Commons Hub.

EDUCATION

BSc Philosophy, Politics & Economics (+ History), Utrecht University 2019–2023
Academic exchange · Business / Managerial Economics, Vrije Universiteit Brussel 2022–2023
Secondary · Latin · Maths · Sciences · Dutch, Collège Saint-Pierre de Jette 2013–2018
Honour: Maths Olympiads Finalist (national top 12).

SUPERPOWERS & SKILLS

Partnerships · Community-building · Go-to-market · Shipping under tight deadlines · Sales & BD · Sponsorship · Ecosystem convening · Public speaking · AI-native building

AI-native: I build and ship solo with AI: Claude, Soda Straw, Lovable, Rosebud, Hugging Face.
Languages: French (native) · English (full professional) · Dutch (working).